

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 5
♥ J 10 6 5 3 2
♦ Q J 9
♣ A

♠ K 9 2
♥ A K 8 7 4
♦ K 10 7
♣ 10 8



♠ A 7 4 3
♥ Q
♦ A 6 4 2
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J 10 6
♥ 9
♦ 8 5 3
♣ K Q J 9 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Dbl

2 ♣¹

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

North opens 1 ♥ and East Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2 ♣ without fear that North will think you have a strong hand. North also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ A 10 6 5 3
 ♦ 10 5 4
 ♣ 10 9 5 4

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ K 7 3

♣ -



♠ 10 3
 ♥ 9 8 4
 ♦ A 9
 ♣ Q 8 7 6 3 2

♠ Q J 2

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 8 6 2

♣ A K J

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠

All Pass

South would have shown one Ace and North wouldn't know what to do next. She might have figured the odds favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. South responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. South agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). South bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

South's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. North realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that North did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces,

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 5 3
♥ 10 5
♦ 8 6 5 4
♣ A Q 7 3

♠ A J 10 8 2

♥ A K 8 2

♦ Q 2

♣ 10 5



♠ Q 9 6
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 10 9
♣ 8 6 4 2

♠ 7 4

♥ Q 7 3

♦ A K J 7 3

♣ K J 9

North opens 1♠. You respond 2♦, a 2/1 force to game. Partner rebids 2♥, showing a 4-card side suit.

You don't have 4♥s, nor do you have 3♠s. You do, however, have stoppers in ♣s so you bid 2NT. North happily says 3NT.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			